CMSAdmin 2.0 User Guide

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Welcome

This guide shows Chelan County staff how to update the county websites with CMSAdmin at **cmsadmin.chelancounty.gov**: sign in, pick your department, edit pages, add files and forms, and publish. You don't need any technical knowledge. Developers should use the separate *CMSAdmin 2.0 Documentation*.

What you can do depends on your role. Your administrator sets it, and the sidebar only shows what your role allows.

Task	Author	HR	PIO	Administrator
Pages, Media Library, Forms, Events, How Do I?	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Job postings and applications	—	Yes	—	Yes
Articles, press releases, emergency alerts	—	—	Yes	Yes
Users, workspaces, navigation menus, settings	—	—	—	Yes

You also work only in the **workspaces** (departments or sites) you are assigned to, for example *Assessor*, *Public Works* or *parks.chelancounty.gov*. If something you need is missing, ask a CMS administrator to change your role or workspaces.

Signing in and finding your way

CMSAdmin has no password: you sign in with your county email plus a 6-digit code sent to your inbox or shown in an authenticator app.

Sign in

1. Go to **cmsadmin.chelancounty.gov** and enter your county email under *County Email Address*. Select **Continue**.
2. Under *Choose Authentication Method*, pick one:
   - **Email One-Time Passcode** — select **Send One-Time Passcode**, then type the 6-digit code from your inbox. Codes last 15 minutes; use **Resend Passcode** if it expired.

- **Use Connected Authenticator App Code** — type the current code from Microsoft Authenticator or Google Authenticator.

3. Select **Verify & Sign In**. You land on the Dashboard, or on the page you were trying to open.

Pair an authenticator app (optional, recommended). On the sign-in screen choose **Connect Your Authenticator**, scan the QR code with Microsoft or Google Authenticator, enter the code it shows, and select **Confirm & Complete Sign In**. After that you can sign in without waiting for email.

> You are signed out after **30 minutes without activity**. Save your work before stepping away; anything unsaved when the session ends is lost.

Pick your workspace. Everything you see and create belongs to the workspace chosen in the selector at the top of the screen. Check it before you start; a page made in the wrong workspace appears on the wrong department's site. The Dashboard also has **Select Department Workspace** under *Choose a Workspace to Manage*.

The Dashboard shows your workspace's recent pages, active online forms, storage use, recent editing activity and **Quick Actions** such as **Add New Page**.

The sidebar groups the tools:

Group	Tools
Main	Dashboard
Content Management	Pages, Events / Calendar, Media Library, Form Builder, Documentation
HRM	Human Resources (job postings)
PIO	Public Information, Articles & Posts
Administration	Workspaces, Users & Roles, Navigation Menus, Settings

Your profile. Open your name in the top-right corner and choose **My Profile** to update your name, job title and phone (**Save Profile Changes**), turn two-factor sign-in on or off, and see which workspaces you can use. The bell icon opens your notifications, such as new form submissions.

Pages

A page goes live when its **Status** is *Active* and its **Visibility** is *Published*; every save is kept as a version you can restore.

Create a page

1. Check the workspace selector, then go to **Pages** and select **Add Page** (or **Add New Page** on the Dashboard).
2. Enter the **Page Title**. The **Page URL** fills in from the title; change it if you want a shorter web address.
3. Choose a **Page Layout**:
   - **Full Width** — one wide column, good for announcements, long text and maps.
   - **Right Sidebar** — main text on the left, with a sidebar for sub-pages, hours and quick links.
4. Select **Continue to Editor**. The page is created and the editor opens.

Edit a page

In **Pages**, use the search box and the *Status*, *Visibility* and *Menu item* filters to find the page, then open it from the *Actions* column. The editor has these parts:

Part	What it's for
Page Title and **Page Content**	The heading and the body text. Use the toolbar for headings, lists, links, tables and images.
Browse Templates	Ready-made blocks: Table of Contents, Office Contact & Hours, Info or Warning Panel, FAQ, Step-by-Step Instructions and more.
Embed Form	Puts one of your workspace's online forms into the page.
Search & Sharing	*Browser / Search Title* and *Summary / Meta Description* (keep it under 160 characters). **Auto-Generate from Content** writes a first draft.
Page Attributes	*Page Assignment*: **Top Level – Called from URL**, or **Assign to Main Menu Item** and pick the item.
Page Layout	Switch between Full Width and Right Sidebar.

Part	What it's for
Publish	Status, Visibility, Revision Note and **Save Changes**. **View Live** opens the public page.

Publish, schedule or hide

1. In the **Publish** panel set **Status** to *Active*.
2. Set **Visibility**:
   - *Published* — visible to the public.
   - *Draft* — saved, not public yet.
   - *Scheduled* — pick a date and time in **Publish On**.
   - *Hidden* — kept but not shown.
3. Optionally type a **Revision Note**, e.g. *Updated fee schedule*.
4. Select **Save Changes** (**Create Page** for a brand-new page). If the accessibility checker found errors, you'll be asked to review them first — see the next section.

> Pages can't be deleted, because the county must keep a record of what was published. To take a page down, set **Status** to *Inactive* or **Visibility** to *Hidden*.

Sub-pages (Right Sidebar layout)

On a Right Sidebar page, select **Create Subpage**, enter a **Title / Header**, choose its **Position**, write the **Body**, and select **Save Subpage**. Sub-pages show as a list in the page's sidebar.

Folder Explorer (document lists)

To show a folder of documents on a page, such as meeting agendas, select **Add Folder Explorer Item** under *Page Attributes*. Enter a **Title**, the **Server Absolute Path** and **Web URL Relative Path** of the folder, choose an **Option Layout** (Full Width or 3/9 grid) and select **Add Item**. Ask your administrator if you don't know the folder path.

Restore an older version

1. Select **Revisions** at the top of the editor, or the version link (e.g. *v7 (7 snapshots)*) in the Publish panel.

2. Pick a version from the list on the left. Compare it with the current page using **Visual Diff**, **Side-by-Side**, **Snapshot Preview** or **HTML Code**. Added words are highlighted; removed words are struck through.
3. Select **Restore this Version** and confirm. The current page is saved as a backup version first, so a restore can always be undone.

Select **Snapshot Now** to save a version on demand, for example before a big rewrite.

Accessibility checker

The county's websites must meet the ADA accessibility standard (WCAG 2.1 AA), so the page and article editors check your content as you type and stop you before publishing anything with a serious problem.

Read the bar. Above the editor you'll see *Compliant* or a count of errors and warnings, with buttons for each area: **Images**, **Headings**, **Links**, **Tables**, **Readability**. **Errors** (red) must be fixed before publishing; **Warnings** (amber) should be.

Fix an issue

1. Select **Inspect Diagnostics** to open the list. Filter it with **All**, **Errors** or **Warnings**.
2. Each item explains the problem and how to fix it. Use **Locate in Editor** to jump to the spot; it briefly flashes.
3. Where offered, **Quick Fix** corrects it for you.

Common problems and fixes

The checker says	Do this
Image has no alt text	Describe what the image shows, e.g. *Commissioners at the 2027 budget hearing*. Don't write "photo" or the file name.
Image is decorative	Tick *Decorative* instead of writing alt text, so screen readers skip it.
Alt text too long (over 150 characters)	Shorten it; put the full explanation in the caption or text.
Heading 1 in the body	The page title is the only Heading 1. Start sections at Heading 2 (Quick Fix does this).

The checker says	Do this
Skipped heading level	Go Heading 2 → Heading 3 → Heading 4 in order; don't jump from 2 to 4.
Empty heading	Delete it or type text into it.
Unclear link text	Replace "click here" or "read more" with what the link opens, e.g. *Download the 2026 fee schedule (PDF)*.
Web address used as link text	Use words instead of the full URL.
Link opens a new tab without warning	Add "(opens in a new tab)", or let Quick Fix do it.
Table has no header row	Make the first row headers (Quick Fix). Add a caption saying what the table shows.
All-caps text, pale coloured text, or many blank lines	Use normal capitals, the default text colour, and headings or spacing instead of empty lines.

Publishing with errors. If you save a published page that still has errors, a box asks you to **Review in Drawer** or **Publish Anyway**. Only use *Publish Anyway* for urgent public-safety updates, and fix the errors straight after.

Media Library

The Media Library holds your workspace's photos and documents; anything you upload here can be placed on pages, articles and events.

Browse. Open **Media Library** in the sidebar. You see the folders of your current workspace (shown next to *Workspace:*), usually **media** or **images** for pictures and **documents** for files. Double-click a folder to open it, use the path at the top to go back, and type in **Filter this folder by name** to find a file.

Upload a file

1. Select **Upload Files**.
2. Under *Destination Workspace & Folder*, check the **Workspace / Department Site** and choose the **Repository Subfolder**: *media/* for photos, logos and graphics, *documents/* for PDFs, forms and spreadsheets.

3. Drag the file onto *Choose a file or drag & drop it here*, or select it.
4. For an image, write the **Alternative Text** (required): a short description of what the image shows. Add a **Display Title** and **Caption** if useful.
5. Select **Save & Upload to Repository**.

You can upload	You can't upload
Images: .jpg .jpeg .png .gif .webp .svg	Programs and scripts: .exe .bat .ps1 .cfm .cfc .asp .jsp
Documents: .pdf .docx .xlsx .pptx .txt .csv	

Organize. Select **New folder**, type a **New folder name**, and select **Create**. Only empty folders can be deleted, and the top-level workspace folders can't be deleted at all. Name files clearly, e.g. `2026-budget-hearing-agenda.pdf`; the name becomes part of the web address.

Put a file on a page. In any editor, use the image or link button on the toolbar and choose the media library option. The *Select Asset from Media Library* window opens on your workspace; pick the file and select **Insert**. Its alt text and caption come along with it.

> Before replacing or renaming a file, remember that pages linking to the old name will break. Upload the new version with the same name, or update the links.

Forms, Events and How Do I? links

These three tools collect information from the public, list county meetings, and power the *How Do I?* quick-links on chelancounty.gov.

Online forms

1. Open **Form Builder** and choose **+ Create / Builder Studio**. Select **Templates** to start from a ready-made form (Report a Problem, Pest Report, Building Permit, Satisfaction Survey and others), or keep the blank canvas.
2. Select **Form Settings** on the right. Enter the title, a short description, the department, the confirmation message, and the **alert email** that should receive submissions.

3. Click items under **Form Elements** to add questions: Short Text, Email, Phone, Paragraph, Number, Date Picker, Dropdown, Radio Group, Checkboxes, Agreement, File Upload, Address Block, Star Rating, Signature. Section Title, Text / Instructions and Divider only display text.
4. Click each question on the canvas and fill in **Field Settings**: a clear label, help text, **Required** only if truly needed, and width (100%, 50% or 33%).
5. Select **Preview Form** and try it on desktop, tablet and mobile.
6. Select **Save Form** and wait for **Saved to database**.

> **A new form goes live as soon as you save it.** Have someone check the wording and alert email first, and test it before sharing the link.

Share it. Share & Embed gives you the public link and embed code. To put the form on a page, use **Embed Form** in the page editor.

Read submissions. Open **Forms**, find the form, and open its submissions to read them or export a spreadsheet (CSV). Spam is filtered automatically; a submission sent within 3 seconds of the page loading is held as suspicious.

Remove a form. The trash-can button on the **Forms** page stops new submissions; past submissions are kept.

Events / Calendar

1. Open **Events / Calendar** and select **Add Event**.
2. **Title, category and department.** Enter the **Event Title**, choose an **Event Category** and the **Department / Workspace**, and write a short summary and full description. Tick *Feature on County Homepage Spotlight* or *Official Public Hearing / Legal Notice* when they apply.
3. **Date and schedule.** Set start and end dates and times, or tick **All-Day**. Quick buttons fill common times such as *9:00 AM – 11:30 AM* and *6:00 PM – 8:00 PM*.
4. **Location.** Pick a preset (BOCC Chambers, Courthouse, Comm. Dev, Expo Center) or type the building, room and address. Add the Zoom or Teams link and dial-in details for virtual meetings.
5. **Agenda and contact.** Use **Browse** to attach the agenda packet from the Media Library, and add the minutes or recording link afterwards. Enter the contact person, email and phone.
6. Select **Save Event**.

Switch between **Calendar Grid**, **Events List** and **Public Calendar Preview** at the top. Use **Categories** to add categories with their own colours.

How Do I? links

The *How Do I?* page on chelancounty.gov lists common tasks under verbs like *Apply for*, *Pay*, *Report* and *Request*.

1. Go to **Pages › How Do I** and select **Add "How Do I" Link**.
2. Choose the **How Do I Category** and **Department / Workspace**, and type the **Action / Link Label**, e.g. *a building permit*.
3. Choose the **Destination Type**: **Site Page**, **Online Form**, **Custom Path** or **External URL**, then pick or type the destination.
4. Keep **Published** ticked to show it on the website, and select **Save "How Do I" Link**.

Preview /howdoi & Mega-Menu shows how the links will look on the public site.

PIO tasks: articles, press releases and emergency alerts

These tools appear under **PIO** in the sidebar for Public Information Officers and administrators.

Write an article

1. Open **Articles & Posts** and start a new article.
2. Enter the **Article Headline / Title**, a **Story Excerpt / Teaser Summary**, and the **Full Story Content**. The **URL Slug** fills in from the headline.
3. Under **Featured Cover Image**, select **Browse** to pick a photo from the Media Library. Then either write the **Alternative Text** (use **Suggest from Headline** for a first draft) or mark the image as decorative. Add a visible **Story Caption** and **Photo Credit** if needed.
4. Under **Taxonomy**, choose the **Primary Category** and type **Tags** separated by commas.
5. Under **Publish Settings**, choose the **Assigned Workspace / Department**, the **Publication Status** (*Published Live*, *Draft* or *Archived*) and the **Publish Date & Time**.
6. Check the accessibility bar (it also checks the cover image), then select **Save Article** or **Save & Publish**.

Issue a press release

1. Open **Press Releases** and start a new release.

2. Enter the **Press Release Headline**, **Dateline** (e.g. *Wenatchee, WA*), **Executive Summary** and **Full Release Text**.
3. Fill in the **Media Contact**: name, title, phone and email.
4. If there is a signed PDF, upload it to the Media Library and paste its link into **Official Signed PDF URL**.
5. Set **Status** (*Active* to publish, *InActive* to hold, *Archive* when it's old) and the **Release Date & Time**, then select **Save Press Release**.

Send an emergency alert

An alert shows as a coloured banner across the top of the county websites the moment you dispatch it.

1. Open **Emergency Alerts** and select **+ New Emergency Broadcast**, or click one of the **Quick-Dispatch Presets** (e.g. wildfire evacuation levels, pass closures, flood warnings, courthouse closures). You can also pick one from **Load Standard Incident Preset**.
2. Edit the **Incident Headline** and **Advisory Message Body** for this incident.
3. Choose the **Severity Level & Banner Color**:

Level	Use for
Danger / Red (Critical)	Immediate danger to life: Level 3 “GO NOW” evacuations, major flooding
Warning / Orange	Level 2 “BE SET” notices, pass closures, office closures, extreme fire weather
Notice / Blue	Detours, public health notices, reminders

4. Optionally add an **Action Link URL** and **Button Label**, e.g. a link to the evacuation map.
5. Choose the **Target Site / Workspace**: *All County Portals*, *chelancounty.gov only*, or one department's site. Pick an **Incident Category**.
6. Leave **Deploy Immediately** ticked to go live now. Untick **Allow citizens to dismiss banner** for life-safety alerts so the banner can't be closed.
7. Select **Dispatch Alert**. While an alert is live, a badge shows in the CMSAdmin header.

End an alert as soon as it no longer applies: find it in **Emergency Broadcast History & Archives** and switch it off. Old alerts stay in the history.

HR tasks: job postings and applications

Job postings you mark *Active* appear on the public **Careers** page (`/careers`), where people apply online.

Post a job

1. Open **Human Resources** under **HRM** and create a new posting.
2. **Position Identification: Title**, **Class Code / PCN**, the **SiteID / Department Workspace**, the **Direct Supervisor**, and whether it is a supervisory position.
3. **Job Description:** write the duties, qualifications and how to apply.
4. **Status & Timeline:** choose the **Status Code**, the **Post Date**, and either an **Application Deadline** or **Open Until Filled**.
5. **Compensation & Classification:** job type (Full-Time, Part-Time, Seasonal, Temporary, On-Call / Relief), FLSA class (Non-Exempt or Exempt), **Min** and **Max Salary**, pay frequency (Hourly, Monthly, Annual) and salary group or union.
6. **Workplace Location** and, if you have one, the **Job Description PDF** attachment. Then save.

Status	What the public sees
Active	Listed on Careers and accepting applications
Draft	Hidden; for internal preview only
Reviewing	Applications closed while you review
Closed	Recruitment finished

Review applications

1. Open **Candidate Applications** from the Job Postings screen.
2. Filter by **Application Status** (*New*, *Under Review*, *Interview*, *Hired*) and **Position Opening**, or search by name.
3. Open an application to read it, then change its status as the candidate moves forward.
4. Select **Export CSV** to download the list as a spreadsheet.

> Applications contain personal information. Don't forward exports by email or save them outside approved HR storage.

Administrator tasks

The **Administration** group is only visible to CMS administrators.

Add or change a staff account

1. Open **Users & Roles** and add a new user (or open an existing one to edit).
2. Enter their name and **@chelancounty.gov** email. There is no password to set; they sign in with emailed codes.
3. Pick one role card: **Author**, **HR**, **PIO** or **Administrator**. The summary shows what that role can reach.
4. Under **Assigned Workspaces & Sites**, tick the departments and sites they work on. Use **All Departments**, **All Sites** or the global option for county-wide staff.
5. Save. To stop someone signing in, switch their account to inactive instead of deleting it.

Check what someone sees. Users & Roles › Roles shows the full permission matrix. The role simulator (`/users/simulate?role=pio` , also `author` , `hr` , `admin`) shows the CMS exactly as that role sees it, with a banner reminding you that you're simulating.

Workspaces

Open **Workspaces** to see every department and site with staff counts and folder status. Use the tabs to switch between departments and sites.

- **New workspace:** choose the type (department or site), the code and folder name (both must be unique), department details and contact information. Saving also creates its file folders.
- **Edit** to update contact details, the redirect address or the display order.
- **Delete** hides a workspace; its records are kept.

Navigation menus

1. Open **Navigation Menus**; the left side shows the **Menu Structure** and the right a **Side Menu Preview**.

2. Select **Add Menu Item**. Enter the **Label**, an optional **Icon**, and the **Link type**: **Site page** (pick from the workspace's pages) or **Custom URL**.
3. Choose a **Parent Item** (or *Top level*), set **Status** to *Active* and select **Save Item**.
4. Use the up and down arrows to reorder items. Changes save immediately.

Settings

Screen	What you set
General	County name, main contact details, time zone, maintenance mode
Reading & SEO	Default search and social-sharing text, analytics IDs, robots rules
Media Sizes	Thumbnail sizes and the largest file size staff can upload
System Info	Read-only server, database and disk health, useful when reporting a problem

Troubleshooting and FAQ

Most problems come from the wrong workspace, a page that isn't both *Active* and *Published*, or a session that timed out.

Problem	What to try
My passcode email didn't arrive	Check junk mail, wait a minute, then select **Resend Passcode**. Codes expire after 15 minutes. Pairing an authenticator app avoids this.
"No user account was found"	Use your full @chelancounty.gov address. If it still fails, ask an administrator to create or reactivate your account.
I was sent back to the sign-in page	You were idle for 30 minutes. Sign in again; unsaved changes are lost.
A menu item or tool is missing	Your role doesn't include it. Ask an administrator.

Problem	What to try
I can't find a page or file	Check the workspace selector at the top; you may be in a different department.
My page isn't on the public site	Set **Status** to *Active* and **Visibility** to *Published*, then **Save Changes**. A *Scheduled* page appears at its **Publish On** time. Refresh the public page.
I published something by mistake	Set **Visibility** to *Hidden* (or *Draft*) and save. To undo an edit, restore an earlier version from **Revisions**.
There's no Delete button for a page	That's intentional: county pages are kept as public records. Hide the page instead.
Save asks me to "Review in Drawer"	The accessibility checker found errors. Fix them using **Inspect Diagnostics** — see *Accessibility checker*.
My upload was rejected	Check the file type is allowed and the file is under the size limit. Programs and scripts are always blocked.
I can't delete a folder	Only empty folders can be deleted, and workspace top-level folders never can.
My form isn't sending emails	Check the alert email in **Form Settings**, then ask an administrator to confirm email delivery is set up. Submissions are still saved under **Forms**.
My new form is already public	New forms go live when first saved. Remove it from the **Forms** page if it isn't ready, and recreate it when it is.
An emergency banner is still showing	Switch the alert off in **Emergency Broadcast History & Archives**, then refresh the public site.

Still stuck? Contact your CMS administrator. Say which page or screen you were on, what you clicked, and the exact message you saw; a screenshot helps.